



SOLE SOURCE JUSTIFICATION UNDER FEDERAL SUPPLY SCHEDULE

SECTION 1: IDENTIFICATION OF THE AGENCY AND THE CONTRACTING ACTIVITY

Department of State Contracting Activity	☒ Acquisition Management ☐ Foreign Service Institute ☐ Office of Foreign Missions ☐ U.S. Mission to the United Nations ☐ Overseas Post
Requiring Activity	Bureau of Diplomatic Security, Diplomatic Security Service, Office of Special Investigation (DS/DSS/OSI)

SECTION 2: NATURE AND/OR DESCRIPTION OF THE ACTION BEING APPROVED

Approval is requested to sole source an order under a Federal Supply Schedule contract for the supplies and/or services described in Section 3 on behalf of the Requiring Activity.

The Department of State, Global Bureau of Acquisitions, Office of Diplomatic Mission Support proposes to award a standalone, two-year, time-and-materials order on a sole source basis to Geospatial Consulting Group International, LLC (GCGI), a Small Business and Women-Owned Small Business, to complete the deployment of a specialized geospatial platform that supports real-time threat monitoring and prescriptive, live courses of action for U.S. overseas posts and consulates.

The sole source justification is based on GCGI's unique position in the deployment phase of the DS Geospatial database implementation and their specialized DS-specific system knowledge developed during pre-deployment activities under the predecessor contracts as an ESRI Inc. sub-contractor. Previous contracts were 19AQMM21F4169 and 19AQMM25F0538, awarded to ESRI Inc.

The requirement encompasses **deployment** phase services, including full-scale implementation of ArcGIS Enterprise on DS infrastructure, real-time integration with operational DS systems, production data migration, operational security implementation and monitoring, live user onboarding across multiple DS Directorates, production system performance optimization, 24/7 operational support during critical deployment periods, and ongoing maintenance and sustainment of live production systems.



SECTION 3: DESCRIPTION OF SUPPLIES OR SERVICES REQUIRED TO MEET THE AGENCY'S NEEDS

Geospatial Information System (GIS) support services for the Bureau of Diplomatic Security (DS) Geospatial database, including deployment phase implementation, operational maintenance, and enhancement of web-based ESRI ArcGIS Enterprise applications. Services encompass:

- **Deployment Phase Services:** Full-scale implementation of ArcGIS Enterprise base deployment on DS infrastructure (up to six machines, virtual or physical), including Portal for ArcGIS, ArcGIS Server, ArcGIS Datastore, and ArcGIS Web Adaptor; real-time integration with operational DS systems and Department of State authentication frameworks; production data migration from legacy geospatial systems; operational security implementation and monitoring; live user onboarding and training across multiple DS Directorates; and production system performance optimization.
- **Maintenance and Support Services:** Software support and labor-related maintenance for existing ESRI ArcGIS applications and databases; network monitoring capabilities including utilization analysis, performance issue resolution, traffic monitoring, and outage management; troubleshooting and remediation of system issues; user support and technical assistance; system updates and patches; and security compliance activities.
- **Enhancement and Development Services:** Implementation of new geospatial workflows and tools based on DS priorities; configuration of ESRI applications and services to integrate with ArcGIS Enterprise (including ArcGIS Collector and other mission-critical tools); geodatabase integration and configuration including database creation and administrative role configuration; development of custom geoprocessing tools and automation workflows; and stakeholder engagement to determine ArcGIS Enterprise utilization for analysis, asset management, data visualization, and collaboration.
- **Knowledge Transfer:** Extensive knowledge transfer activities including on-site technical consulting, documentation development for DS-specific workflows and procedures, and training to ensure Government personnel understanding of enterprise deployment operations

Operationally, services provided during the deployment stage will allow DS to fuse and visualize information such as:

1. Incident locations (attacks, demonstrations, crime, cyber/physical events)



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2. Embassy and consulate facilities, safe havens, and evacuation routes
3. Local law enforcement and host nation security assets
4. Travel routes, chokepoints, and environmental hazards

These services are instrumental to assessing threats faster and more accurately, planning protective details and movements safely, and responding to crises with better situational awareness.

The estimated value for the entire period of performance is [REDACTED] inclusive of one option period.

SECTION 4: AUTHORITY AND SUPPORTING RATIONALE

This acquisition is conducted under the authority of the Multiple-Award Federal Supply Schedule Program as implemented in FAR 8.401 using procedures set forth in GSAR 538.71. See GSAR 538.7104-3 Sole source justifications and cite the applicable justification.

☑ GSAM 538.7104-3(b)(1)(ii): Only one source is capable of providing the products, services, or solution required at the level of quality required because the products, services, or solutions are unique or highly specialized.

This requirement builds upon GCGI's previous work under the predecessor ESRI contracts for pre-deployment phase activities. GCGI has completed pre-deployment activities including requirements analysis, system architecture design, custom geodatabase development, DS-specific configuration, integration with Department of State authentication systems, testing, and ATO preparation since 2021.

GCGI developed proprietary institutional knowledge through pre-deployment activities including custom geodatabase schemas tailored to DS operational requirements; DS-specific ArcGIS Enterprise configurations not documented in standard ESRI implementation guides; integration parameters for Department of State authentication systems and DS network infrastructure; and custom Python scripts, geoprocessing tools, and automation workflows designed specifically for DS Directorates.

The services are unique and highly specialized and may be done through other third-party ESRI-certified resellers once the deployment phase is complete. However, GCGI is thoroughly integrated into DS processes. Their DS-specific system knowledge and unique solutions/processes for the current deployment-phase position as an ESRI subcontractor



makes them the only source capable of providing the quality necessary to ensure successful production implementation and project completion.

This requirement originated under a different Directorate within the Bureau of Diplomatic Security (DS), in partnership with the Center for Analytics (CfA). Although the work should have been structured as a non-severable, completion-type effort when originally initiated, it was not. The current requirements office has since assumed responsibility for this capability on a department-wide basis and now seeks to complete deployment of the platform as an integrated, end-to-end solution.

The work involves highly specialized, mission-critical integration and configuration of ESRI-based geospatial capabilities, as well as the continuation of development, testing, and deployment activities already underway. The incumbent possesses unique technical knowledge of the platform architecture, data flows, and operational use cases that are essential to complete deployment within the planned two-year period.

A competitive award among brand-name resellers at this stage of what should have been a non-severable requirement would result in service degradation and critical risks to DS' law enforcement and overseas protection mission and consulates and embassies around the world—it would result in risks to national security.

SECTION 5: DETERMINATION BY THE ORDERING ACTIVITY CONTRACTING OFFICER THAT THE CONTRACT ACTION REPRESENTS THE BEST VALUE CONSISTENT WITH FAR 8.305

The Contracting Officer has determined the anticipated contract action will represent the best value based on the Contracting Officer's plan to follow the procedures in FAR 8.405. Although approval is requested to contract with one source, the Contracting Officer will not award the planned contract action unless the Contracting Officer evaluates and determines that the resultant price is reasonable.

The General Services Administration (GSA) has already determined the prices of supplies offered under schedule contracts to be fair and reasonable. Therefore, ordering activities are not required to make a separate determination of fair and reasonable pricing. The Contracting Officer has determined that the anticipated price(s) will be fair and reasonable based on market research of available U.S. Government pricing provided to the Department, and the CO will seek additional discounts before award.



SECTION 6. DESCRIPTION OF THE MARKET RESEARCH CONDUCTED AMONG SCHEDULE HOLDERS AND THE RESULTS OR A STATEMENT OF THE REASON MARKET RESEARCH WAS NOT CONDUCTED

Market research, conducted in accordance with FAR Part 10 and the FAR Overhaul Deviation Guide for Part 10, was performed by the Bureau of Global Acquisitions in coordination with the DS Geospatial Team. Market research included appropriate engagement with industry, review of existing government-wide contracts, and analysis of available commercial products and services to determine whether they could meet or be modified to meet the Government's requirements:

- **Small Business Dynamic Search Engine:** Searched the Small Business Administration's Dynamic Small Business Search (DSBS) database for small businesses under NAICS code 54151S Computer Systems Design and Related Services]. The search identified six (6) of small businesses registered under this NAICS code. Further analysis was conducted to determine which of these small businesses possess ESRI partnership status and ArcGIS Enterprise deployment capabilities.
- **ESRI Partner Network Search:** Conducted search of the Environmental Systems Research Institute, Inc. (ESRI) Partner Network directory to identify ESRI-certified partners with ArcGIS Enterprise deployment and support capabilities. Cross-referenced ESRI partners with small business registrations in System for Award Management (SAM) to identify small business ESRI partners capable of providing the required services. This search confirmed that multiple small businesses, including women-owned small businesses, maintain ESRI partnerships and possess general ArcGIS technical capabilities.
- **GSA Schedule Review:** Analysis of GSA Federal Supply Schedule contracts for ESRI ArcGIS support services, identifying that time-and-materials are the predominant contract type for geospatial technical support services due to the variable nature of system support and deployment activities. Reviewed GSA Schedule holders under relevant Special Item Numbers (SINs) for information technology professional services and geospatial services.
- **Comparable Contract Analysis:** Review of similar Department of State and other federal agency contracts for geospatial system deployment and support through resources including USAspending.gov and Federal Procurement Data System (FPDS), demonstrating widespread use of time-and-materials contracts for comparable requirements.
- **Industry Practice Validation:** Consultation with geospatial services industry standards confirming that deployment phase support for enterprise GIS platforms is customarily provided on time-and-materials basis due to inherent unpredictability of production environment implementation.

SECTION 7. STATEMENT OF THE ACTIONS, IF ANY, THE AGENCY MAY TAKE TO REMOVE OR OVERCOME ANY BARRIERS THAT LED TO THE RESTRICTED



CONSIDERATION BEFORE ANY SUBSEQUENT ACQUISITION FOR THE SUPPLIES OR SERVICES IS MADE.

To remove or overcome the barriers that necessitate restricted consideration for this acquisition, the Department will undertake the following actions prior to any subsequent acquisitions for these services:

1. Transition Planning for Future Competition

The performance work statement includes a transition plan as a deliverable to be provided within 60 days of contract performance. This plan will identify the minimum time, activities, and technical documentation required to enable a third-party reseller or other qualified vendor to assume performance without degrading mission capability. This plan will establish a realistic transition window that can be incorporated into the next acquisition strategy to support full and open competition, or competition among resellers, as appropriate. The plan, once finalized, will be incorporated into the performance work statement as a contract requirement.

2. Documentation and Knowledge Transfer

During the period of performance, the Government will require the vendor to:

- Produce comprehensive technical, configuration, security, and operational documentation (e.g. governance policies, procedures during DS Major events, etc).
- Standardize interfaces, data flows, and system configurations to the extent practicable; and
- Conduct structured knowledge transfer and training for Government personnel to reduce dependence on any single vendor. These measures will reduce the learning curve and transition risk for any future competing vendor.

3. Stabilization to an Operations and Maintenance (O&M) Posture

The current effort is focused on completing deployment and achieving an integrated operational capability. Once the platform reaches a steady-state O&M posture, requirements will shift from complex, highly specialized integration work to more routine sustainment services. At that point, the Department will:

- Reassess the market to confirm the availability of qualified resellers and integrators; and
- Structure follow-on requirements in a manner that is more readily competed, such as modular tasking or separate lots for integration and O&M.

4. Market Research and Acquisition Strategy for Follow-On Requirements

Prior to any subsequent acquisition, the Department will conduct targeted market



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research to identify capable resellers and integrators with experience in ESRI-based geospatial platforms and global, mission-critical environments. Based on the results, the Department will:

- Refine performance work statements and technical requirements to be vendor-neutral to the maximum extent practicable.
- Evaluate use of multi-award IDIQs, BPAs, or other competitive vehicles that can support competition at the task order level; and
- Consider phased or incremental competition that allows new vendors to compete for discrete, lower-risk work elements.

5. Risk Mitigation Measures for Future Competitions

To address the cost, schedule, and security risks that currently favor continuation with the incumbent ESRI subcontractor, the Government will build specific risk-mitigation measures into future solicitations, such as:

- Requiring offerors to submit detailed transition plans.
- Establishing minimum staffing, training, and clearance requirements; and
- Incorporating transition-in and transition-out CLINs to manage and fund an orderly handover.

By implementing these actions during and immediately following this limited sole source completion effort, the Department intends to remove or significantly reduce the barriers that currently limit competition. The objective is to position the requirement so that subsequent acquisitions for operations, maintenance, and any future enhancements can be competed among qualified resellers and other capable vendors, consistent with the Government's interest in promoting competition while maintaining uninterrupted protection for the diplomatic community.

SECTIONS 8. CERTIFICATIONS

Tailor this Section based on the elements of the action being requested.

TECHNICAL AND REQUIREMENTS CERTIFICATION (GSAR 538.7104-3)

I certify that the facts and representations under my cognizance which are included in this Justification and its supporting acquisition planning documents, except as noted herein, are complete and accurate to the best of my knowledge and belief.



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Technical & Requirements Cognizance:

SIGNATURE:

JASON R KIGHT

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KIGHT
Date: 2026.03.31 16:13:43 -04'00'

Jason Kight
Senior Advisor

Date

CONTRACTING OFFICER CERTIFICATION (GSAR 538.7104-3)

I certify that this submission is accurate to the best of my knowledge, and that it contains complete information necessary to enable other officials to make an informed recommendation for approval or disapproval.

SIGNATURE:

Sara M Marron

Digitally signed by Sara M
Marron
Date: 2026.04.01 14:06:13 -04'00'

Sara M. Marron
Contracting Officer
Bureau of Global Acquisitions

Date

LEGAL SUFFICIENCY REVIEW

This J&A is hereby determined to be legally sufficient.

SIGNATURE:

John W Cox

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Date: 2026.04.01 14:13:34
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John Cox
L/BA

Date



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SIGNATURE:

Adam D Hiland

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Hiland

Date: 2026.04.01 14:16:07 -04'00'

Adam Hiland
Division Chief
Bureau of Global Acquisitions

Date

SECTION 9. APPROVALS

COMPETITION ADVOCATE SIGNATURE:

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Trena Mills
Bureau of Global Acquisitions

Date